

Application of Information & Communication Technologies

Lecture-17

Recap of Lecture 15 & 16

- ◆ Application Software (part 2)
- ◆ Presentation
- ◆ Multimedia
- ◆ Other Applications

Overview of Lecture 17

- ◆ What is a Database?
- ◆ Data, Information, and Tables
- ◆ Components of a Database System (DBMS)
- ◆ Database vs File System



Databases

- A collection of related data organized for quick access and retrieval.
- Stores data in tables (rows and columns).
- Example:
 - Student records, bank transactions, library catalog.

Why Databases Are Needed

Problem with Files

Data duplication

Difficult to search

No security

No relation between files

Benefit of Databases

Centralized storage

Easy querying

Controlled access

Data relationships

Data, Information, and Tables

- Data: Raw facts (e.g., “Ali”, “21”, “CS”).
- Information: Processed data with meaning (e.g., “Ali is 21 years old”).
- Table: A structured collection of data (rows = records, columns = fields).
 - sample student table

StudentID	Name	Age	Department	GPA
101	Ali	21	CS	3.6
102	Sara	22	AI	3.8
103	Bilal	20	SE	3.4
104	Hina	23	IT	3.9

Relational Database

- **Relational database:** Data from several tables is tied together (related) using a field that the tables have in common.



RELATING DATA

Data in various tables can be pulled together by their common field (Product Number).

Order Number	Product Number	Shipment Date	Quantity
1001	A202	1/8	30
1002	A240	1/8	15
1003	A211	1/9	50
1004	A202	1/9	40
1005	A220	1/10	35
1006	A211	1/12	60

INVENTORY ON ORDER TABLE

QUERY

When the user supplies a product number and order size, all other relevant information needed to complete an Order Request screen is gathered and displayed automatically.



ORDER REQUEST SCREEN

Database Software

- ◆ Database management system (DBMS)
 - Used to create, maintain, and access databases.

Components of DBMS

Component

Description

Hardware

Physical devices storing data

Software

DBMS programs like MySQL, Access

Data

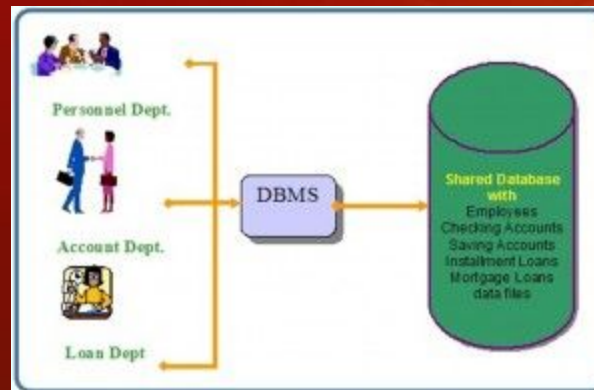
Actual records in tables

Users

People interacting with the database

Procedures

Rules for data access & management



Database vs File System

File System

Stores files independently

Manual data linking

No query facility

Difficult to maintain

Database

Stores related data together

Relationships managed automatically

SQL-based queries

Easier to manage and secure

Summary

- Database = Organized collection of related data.
- DBMS = Software that manages databases.
- File systems are manual, DBMS is automated and reliable.

Suggested Reading

- ◆ Ch-14, Database and Database Management System: Processing and Memory , “Understanding Computers: Today and Tomorrow, Comprehensive”, 15th Edition by Deborah Morley & Charles S. Parker
- ◆ Ch-09, Discovering Computers Fundamentals-Your Interactive Guide -- Gary B Shelly; Misty E Vermaat; Jeffrey J Q